

Lord's Cricket Ground, May 2019

That is how we'll remember Cecile - with a smile. Sasha, your mum smiled her biggest smile when you entered her life. She smiled when, at one of the Ruka's first events, you ran out into the garden, played in the pouring rain, and rolled in the mud, full of joy. She smiled when you danced and sang. She smiled as she watched you grow. She smiled because of the deep love she had for you. That love will always be with you.

May you find comfort in the beautiful memories you shared, and may her love continue to guide and strengthen you through the days ahead.

You are in our thoughts, and we are here for you.

Stefania, Mark and Yeva

Cecile was a warm, bright funny generous creative person who cared passionately about her daughter Sasha and international adoption and was a good friend when one was needed. I remember lovely walks on the beach in Bournemouth with Sky, staying in her and Sasha's house in Bournemouth surrounded by things from all over the world, and laughing together. Having intense conversations as Sasha prepared to go off to Uni and, when I needed a friend, she reminded me about working in the Kalahari and how we all need a tribe sometimes and she offered to be part of mine.

She will be much missed, may her memory be for a blessing.

Best

Jeanette Copperman